

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer

110.17

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

13-3

Manual Section Number

110.17

Manual Section Title

Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

01/28/2005

Ending Effective Date of this Version

02/25/2026

Implementation Date

04/18/2005

Description Information

Benefit Category

Incident to a physician's professional Service

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

Oxaliplatin (Eloxatin™), irinotecan (Camptosar®), cetuximab (Erbix™), and bevacizumab (Avastin™) are anti-cancer chemotherapeutic agents approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the treatment of colorectal cancer. Anti-cancer chemotherapeutic agents are eligible for coverage when used in accordance with FDA-approved labeling (see section 1861(t)(2)(B) of the Social Security Act (the Act)), when the off-label use is supported in one of the authoritative drug compendia listed in section 1861(t)(2)(B)(ii)(I) of the Act, or when the Medicare Administrative Contractor (MAC) determines an off-label use is medically accepted based on guidance provided by the Secretary (section 1861(t)(2)(B)(ii)(II)).

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

Pursuant to this national coverage determination (NCD), the off-label use of clinical items and services, including the use of the studied drugs oxaliplatin, irinotecan, cetuximab, or bevacizumab, are covered in specific clinical trials identified by the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS). The clinical trials identified by CMS for coverage of clinical items and services are sponsored by the National Cancer Institute (NCI) and study the use of one or more off-label uses of these four drugs in colorectal cancer and in other cancer types. The list of identified trials is on the CMS Web site at:

<http://www.cms.hhs.gov/coverage/download/id90b.pdf> .

C. Other

This policy does not alter Medicare coverage for items and services that may be covered or non-covered according to the existing national coverage policy for Routine Costs in a Clinical Trial (NCD Manual section 310.1). Routine costs will continue to be covered as well as other items and services provided as a result of coverage of these specific trials in this policy. The basic requirements for enrollment in a trial remain unchanged.

The existing requirements for coverage of oxaliplatin, irinotecan, cetuximab, bevacizumab, or other anticancer chemotherapeutic agents for FDA-approved indications or for indications listed in an approved compendium are not modified.

MACs shall continue to make reasonable and necessary coverage determinations under section 1861(t)(2)(B)(ii)(II) of the Act based on guidance provided by the Secretary for medically accepted uses of off-label indications of oxaliplatin, irinotecan, cetuximab,

bevacizumab, or other anticancer chemotherapeutic agents provided outside of the identified clinical trials appearing on the CMS website noted above.

Cross Reference

[CED page](#) 

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 588 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

38

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R38NCD.pdf> 

Revision History

06/2005 - Use of oxaliplatin (Eloxatin™), irinotecan (Camptosar®), cetuximab (Erbitux™), or bevacizumab (Avastin™) covered in clinical trials identified by CMS and sponsored by National Cancer Institute. Effective date 01/28/2005. Implementation date 04/18/2005 for Carriers, 07/05/2005 for FI's. ([TN 38](#) ) (CR 3742)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Anticancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer \(CAG-00179N\)](#) 
- [First reconsideration for Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer \(CAG-00179R\)](#) 

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer - RETIRED	2	02/25/2026 - N/A	View
Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer	1	01/28/2005 - 02/25/2026	You are here